

Define Your Product

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. What problem does your product website solve or address?

The problem my product website solves is expensive textbooks and the waste of textbooks. It does this by allowing students to resell their used textbooks to other students at a discounted price.

2. What is your product idea? How does your website support this idea and help solve the problem?

The product idea is a website where students can sell their used textbooks they no longer need at a lower price than MSRP to students who need the textbook. The website supports this idea and helps solve the problem by giving students information on how it works, and providing them the environment to do so.

3. What type of website are you building? (i.e., e-commerce, brochure, portfolio, media, nonprofit, etc.)

The website I am building is an e-commerce website, and I might add a small brochure section explaining how it works and the overall purpose.

4. What is your mission statement? Summarize what your product does, who it's for, and why it matters.

Recyclopedica is an e-commerce website for students looking to sell or purchase textbooks. Vendors list textbooks they no longer need for a discounted price for buyers who need them! It matters because it lessens the financial burden of higher education.

Profile Of Target Audience

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. Who is the primary audience that your product is trying to reach? Include the following details about your target audience:

- Demographics

- What is the age range of your target audience?

17 to 30, although there could be older students.

- What is the gender distribution?

50/50, not targeting a specific gender.

- Which country do your visitors live in?

The United States of America.

- Do they live in urban or rural areas?

Both urban and rural.

- Socioeconomic Details

- What is the average income of visitors?

No average, maybe \$500+ a year.

- What level of education do they have?

Currently pursuing college level education or higher.

- What is their marital or family status?

Single or married, does not matter.

- What is their occupation?

A full time or part time student.

- How many hours do they work per week?

No specification.

- Web Behavior

- How often do they use the web?

Often, they need to have some technological literacy.

- What kind of device do they use to access the web?

Any device, preferably a personal computer or laptop.

Recyclopedia – Fictional Target Audience Visitors

Name	Sex	Age	Location	Occupation	Income	Web Use
Emily Carter	Female	19	Kingston, RI	College Student	\$9,000/year	Uses Google, Instagram, TikTok, Amazon, and school websites daily. Frequently searches for cheaper textbooks before each semester.
Marcus Johnson	Male	21	Providence, RI	College Student / Part-time Employee	\$18,000/year	Uses Google, YouTube, Reddit, Discord, and online marketplaces regularly. Often compares prices online before purchasing school supplies.
Sophia Patel	Female	22	Warwick, RI	College Student / Part-time Tutor	\$15,000/year	Uses Instagram, TikTok, Google, Amazon, and Facebook Marketplace. Searches for affordable textbooks and sells old textbooks after finishing courses.
Daniel Nguyen	Male	20	Cranston, RI	College Student	\$7,500/year	Uses Google, YouTube, TikTok, and online shopping sites frequently. Looks for used items because he has a limited student budget.

Target Audience Overview

These fictional visitors represent different types of students who could use Recyclopedia. They share a common need for **affordable** textbooks but have different online habits and financial situations. Some are primarily interested in buying **used textbooks** for less money, while others are interested in selling textbooks they no longer need. Their frequent use of search engines, social media, and online marketplaces makes Recyclopedia a practical way for students to find and exchange used textbooks at more affordable prices.



Recyclopededia – Why People Come & What They Do

Different students. Different goals. Same mission — affordable textbooks.

Fictional Visitor	Reason for Visiting	Tasks They Will Complete	How This Helps Recyclopededia
 Emily Carter Age: 19 Location: Kingston, RI Occupation: College Student	- Find cheaper textbooks for upcoming semesters - Compare prices before buying - Look for specific editions required for her classes	- Search for textbooks by course or ISBN - View seller ratings and reviews - Add items to cart and complete a purchase	- Increases buyer activity and sales - Builds trust through reviews and ratings - Helps move more listings and keep the platform active
 Marcus Johnson Age: 21 Location: Providence, RI Occupation: College Student / Part-time Employee	- Sell textbooks he no longer needs - Make extra money - Find affordable books for next semester	- Create a seller account - List a textbook with photos and description - Set a price and manage messages from buyers	- Increases supply of used textbooks - Grows the seller community - Keeps inventory fresh and diverse
 Sophia Patel Age: 22 Location: Warwick, RI Occupation: College Student / Part-time Tutor	- Buy used textbooks for lower prices - Sell textbooks after finishing courses - Save money and reduce waste	- Search for textbooks and filter by price/condition - Contact sellers with questions - List and sell her old textbooks	- Increases both buying and selling activity - Supports sustainability goals - Builds a loyal, repeat user base
 Daniel Nguyen Age: 20 Location: Cranston, RI Occupation: College Student	- Find the most affordable options - Look for used books to stay within his budget - Quickly browse and compare prices	- Use the search function - View detailed book conditions and photos - Add items to cart or save listings for later	- Drives consistent traffic from budget-conscious students - Increases the number of views on listings - Helps fulfill the goal of making textbooks more affordable

Website Requirements

By addressing the questions below, you'll gain valuable insights into how to design a website that meets your goals and expectations.

1. Purpose & Goals

Answer the following questions in your document:

- What is the primary goal of your website (i.e., promote a service, sell a product, educate users, raise awareness, etc.)?

The primary goal of Recyclopededia is to promote a service. The website is meant to connect students who are interested in selling and buying textbooks.

- What is the most important action you want users to take on your site (i.e., sign up, purchase, read articles, submit a form, etc.)?

The most important actions I want users to take on my site is being able to browse through and post listings of textbooks.

2. Content & Features

Answer the following questions in your document:

- What content and features are essential to help users achieve their goals? List critical pages and features (i.e., About, Contact Form, Product Gallery, FAQs, Reviews, etc.).

Two features that are essential for users on Recyclopedia to achieve their goals are to be able to post their textbooks for sale and to be able to browse through textbooks that are up for sale. Critical pages that are necessary for Recyclopedia's success are an about page, a direct message page between users, a textbook gallery, FAQs, reviews, a posting page for textbooks, and a profile page.

- What will your homepage highlight? Think about the first impression and what visitors need to see right away.

The homepage will highlight the textbooks that are up for sale. It's important for the first impression to show that textbooks are available for much cheaper prices than buying it directly from the publisher or other sources.

3. Look & Feel

Answer the following questions in your document:

- Do you have examples of websites that inspire your design? List 1–2 examples and what you like about them (i.e., layout, colors, interactivity, etc.).

Two websites that inspire my design for Recyclopedia are Indeed.com and Apple.com. I really like the layout of Indeed for job listings and so I want to go for something like that for Recyclopedia's textbook listings. For Apple, I enjoy their transitions and color choices for showcasing some iPhones. I would like my About screen to be something similar to that.

- How would you describe the overall style of your site (i.e., modern, bold, minimalist, playful, professional, etc.)?

I want it to be professional looking / modern. Maybe some playful styles could show up during holidays or special times.

- Do you have preferences for color, fonts, or imagery? If not, what mood or personality do you want the site to convey?

I want brown and white to be the primary colors for the website because they remind me of books. I want lots of images of books, and for fonts I

want either Bodoni or Caslon along with Baskerville and Didot. I want the site to convey professionalism.

Design & Prototyping

In this final section, you'll bring together your ideas and planning to shape the visual direction of your product website. You'll document your design choices and development strategy through diagrams, sketches, and visuals that guide your build process.

1. SDLC Approach & Timeline

In your answer document, outline how you plan to build your website using the SDLC. Your plan should include:

- The SDLC model you've chosen (Waterfall, Agile, Scrum, etc.).
- A clear timeline of phases and milestones.
- A visual representation of your timeline (e.g., Gantt chart, flowchart, or detailed bullet list).

You may create this manually or with AI tools ([ChatGPT](#), [Gantt Chart AI](#)).

SDLC Model: Agile

For the development of Recyclopeda, I plan to use the **Agile SDLC model**. Agile focuses on developing a website in smaller sections called iterations or sprints rather than trying to complete the entire project at once. This will allow me to test features as they are developed, identify problems early, and make changes based on feedback. Since Recyclopeda is an e-commerce website, Agile will also allow me to improve the user experience as I learn more about what students need when buying and selling used textbooks.

Timeline and Phases

Week 1 – Planning and Requirements

- Identify the target audience and their needs.
- Define the main purpose of Recyclopeda.
- Determine the website's required features.
- Create user personas and user stories.
- Decide what information will be stored in the database.

Week 2 – Design

- Create wireframes and page layouts.
- Design the homepage, product listings, search page, login page, and user account pages.
- Plan the navigation and overall website structure.
- Create the visual style and branding for Recyclopedia.

Weeks 3–4 – Sprint 1: Core Website

- Build the homepage.
- Create user registration and login.
- Build the textbook browsing and search features.
- Create the basic textbook listing system.
- Test the first version of the website.

Weeks 5–6 – Sprint 2: Buying and Selling

- Add the ability for users to create textbook listings.
- Add textbook descriptions, prices, photos, and conditions.
- Add shopping cart and purchasing functionality.
- Allow users to edit or remove their listings.
- Test buying and selling features.

Week 7 – Sprint 3: Testing and Improvements

- Test the website on different devices.
- Fix bugs and broken features.
- Improve navigation and accessibility.
- Collect feedback from potential users.
- Make changes based on the feedback.

Week 8 – Finalization and Launch

- Perform final testing.
- Check that all major features work correctly.
- Make final design and usability improvements.
- Prepare the website for launch.
- Deploy the completed Recyclopedia website.



Recyclopededia

Buy. Sell. Save. Repeat.

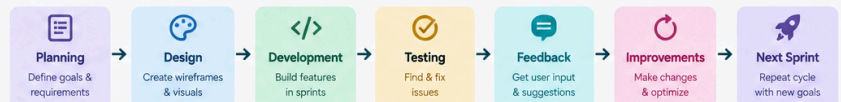
Website Development Plan

Agile SDLC – Timeline & Phases

Phase	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Week 6	Week 7	Week 8
1 Planning & Requirements - Identify target audience and needs - Define purpose and required features - Create user personas and user stories - Plan database structure								
2 Design - Create wireframes and page layouts - Design key pages and navigation - Plan visual style and branding								
3 Sprint 1: Core Website - Build homepage - Create user registration and login - Add search and browsing features - Test first version								
4 Sprint 2: Buying and Selling - Add listing creation and management - Include photos, descriptions, and prices - Add cart and purchasing functionality - Test buying and selling features								
5 Sprint 3: Testing & Improvements - Test on different devices - Fix bugs and improve navigation - Collect user feedback - Make changes based on feedback								
6 Finalization & Launch - Perform final testing - Check all major features - Final design and usability improvements - Deploy website								

Agile Development Cycle

The Agile process will be repeated throughout the project, allowing for continuous testing, feedback, and improvements in each sprint.

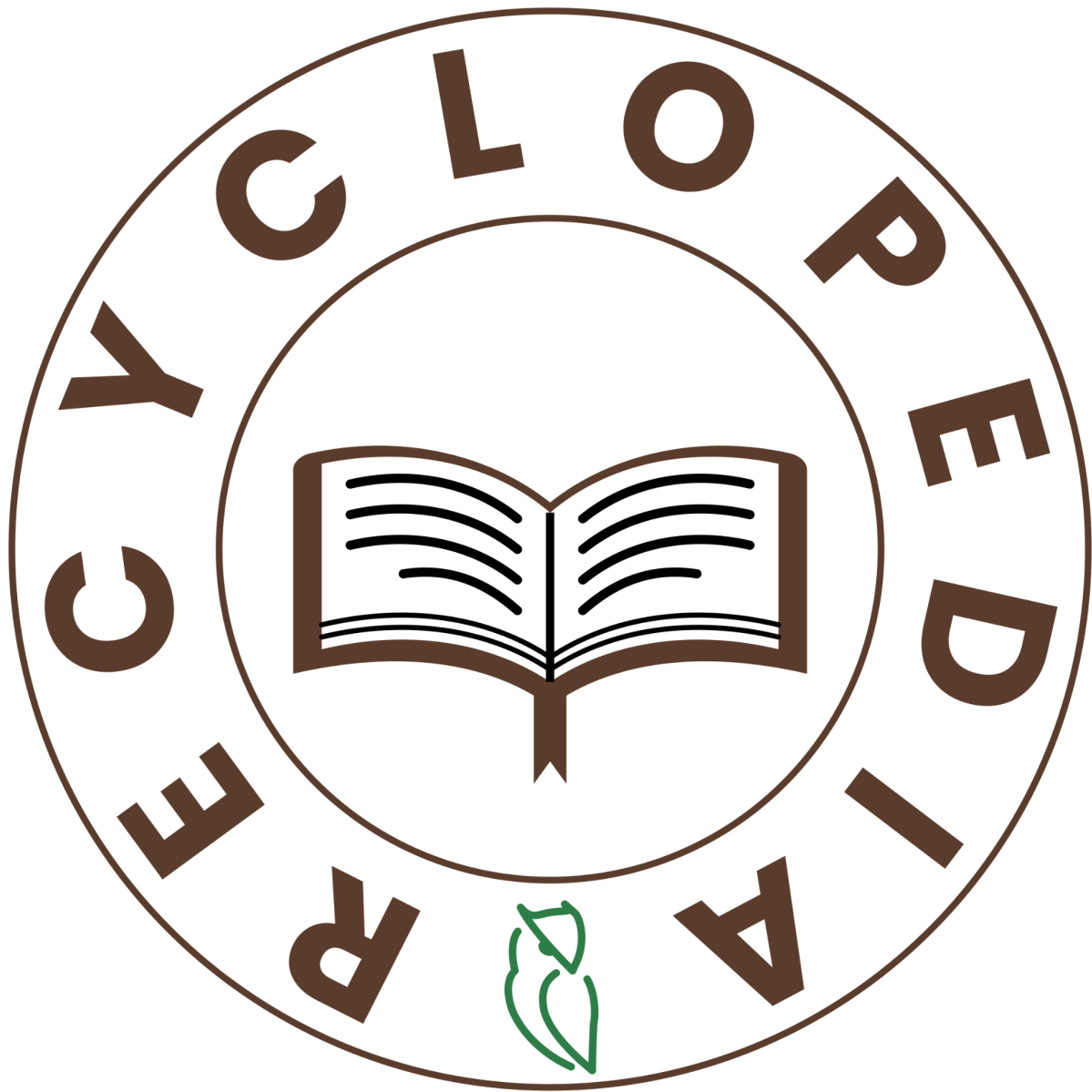


2. Original Logo

Design a logo for your product website that visually captures your brand identity. Your logo must include:

- The name of your product.
- An image, icon, or design that represents your product.
- A transparent background (export as PNG).

Use free tools like [Pixlr X](#) to create your logo. You can check out a [video tutorial](#) or [written tutorial](#) on how to create a logo in Pixlr X.

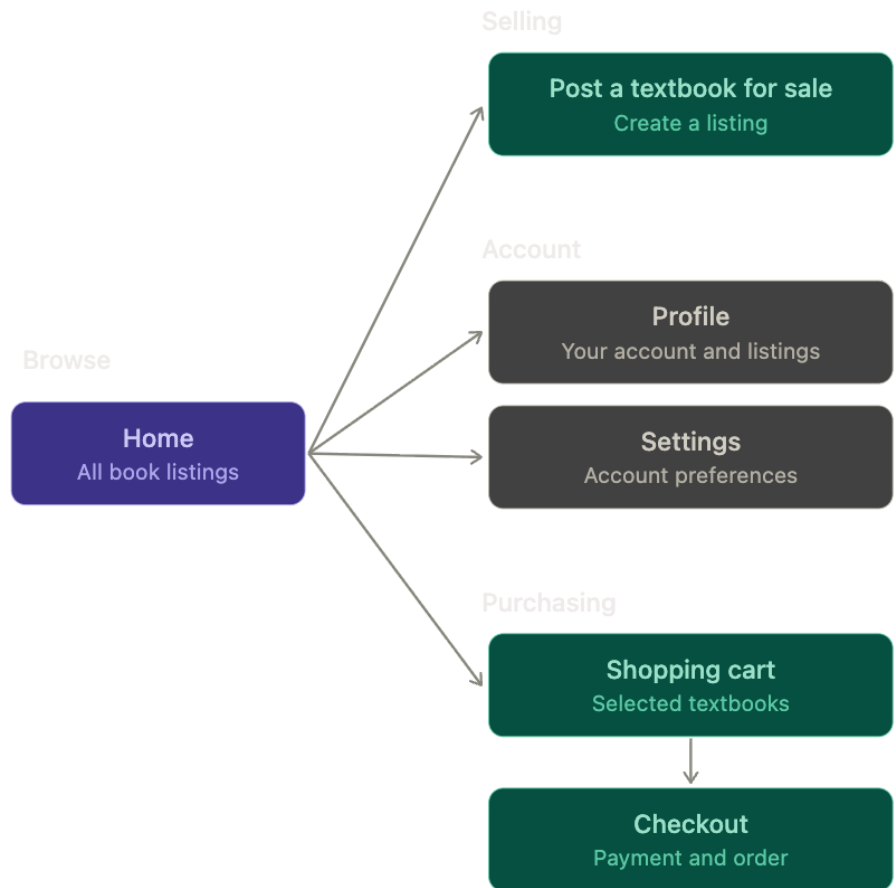


3. Site Map

Create a site map that shows how your site will be structured and how users will navigate between pages. Your site map should:

- Illustrate the structure and grouping of your web pages.
- Clearly shows how users will navigate between the pages.
- Reflect any feedback you received from your peers during the lab.

You can create your site map manually on paper, using draw.io or with AI tools ([Slickplan](https://Slickplan.com), Octopus.do).

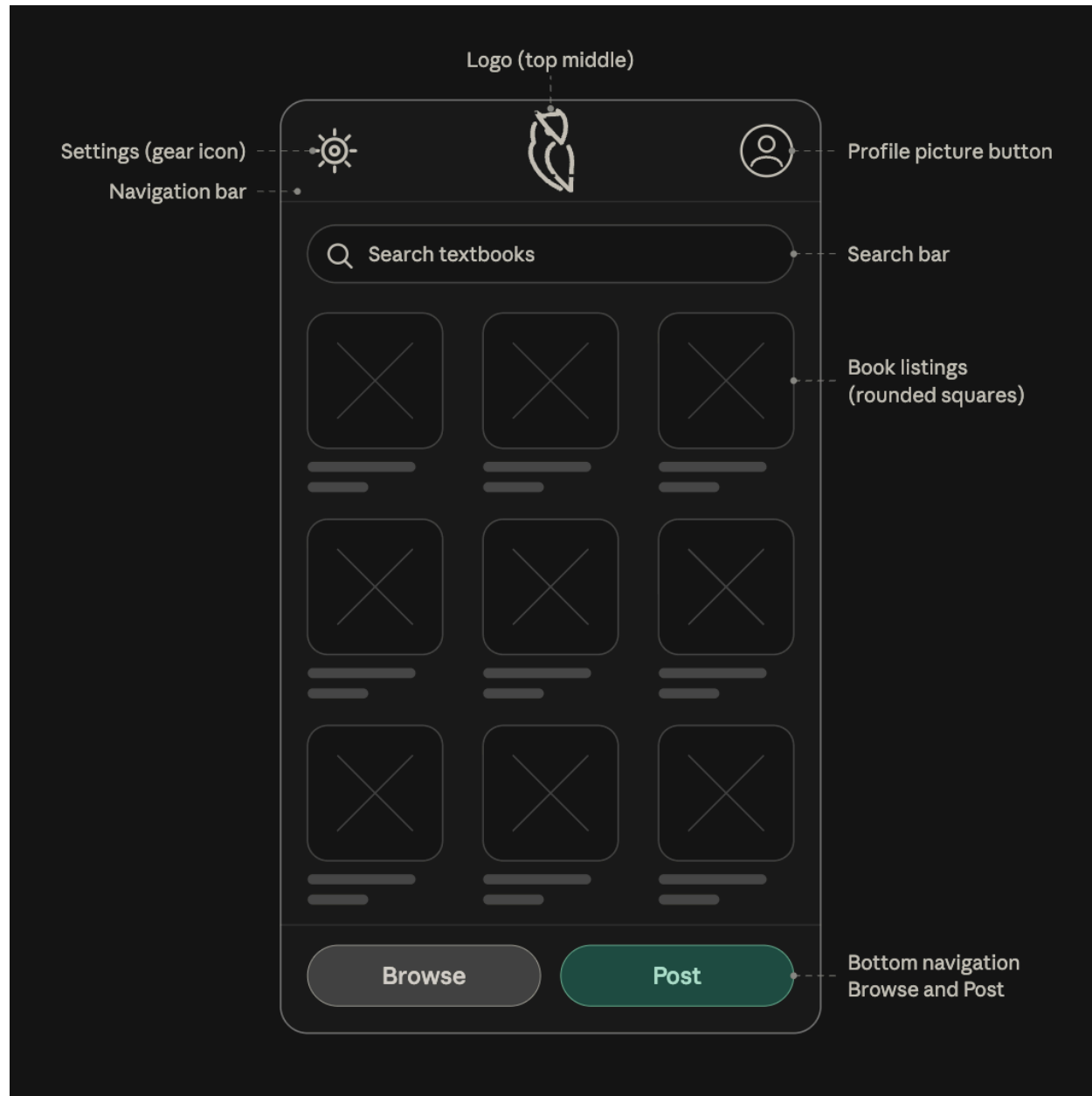


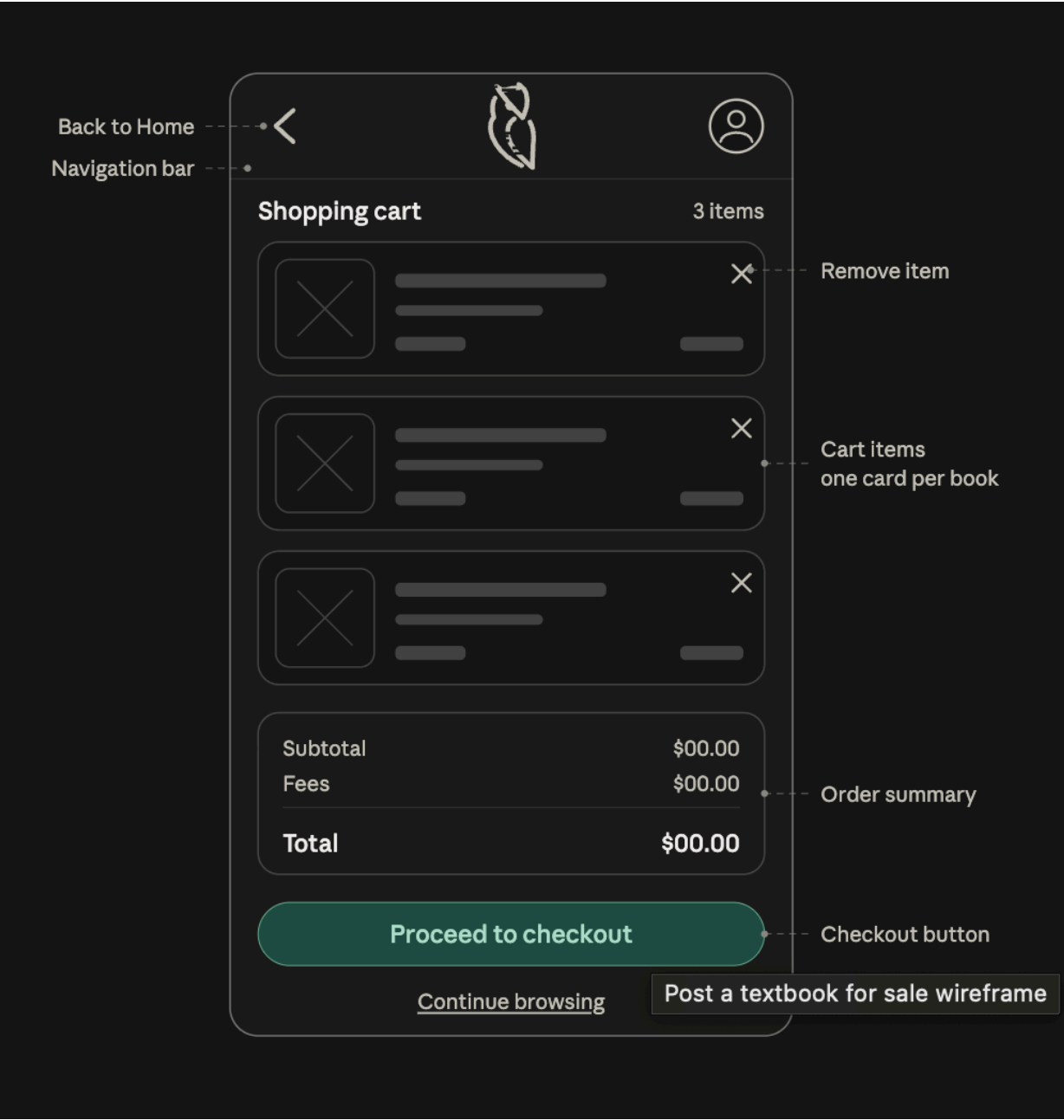
4. Wireframes

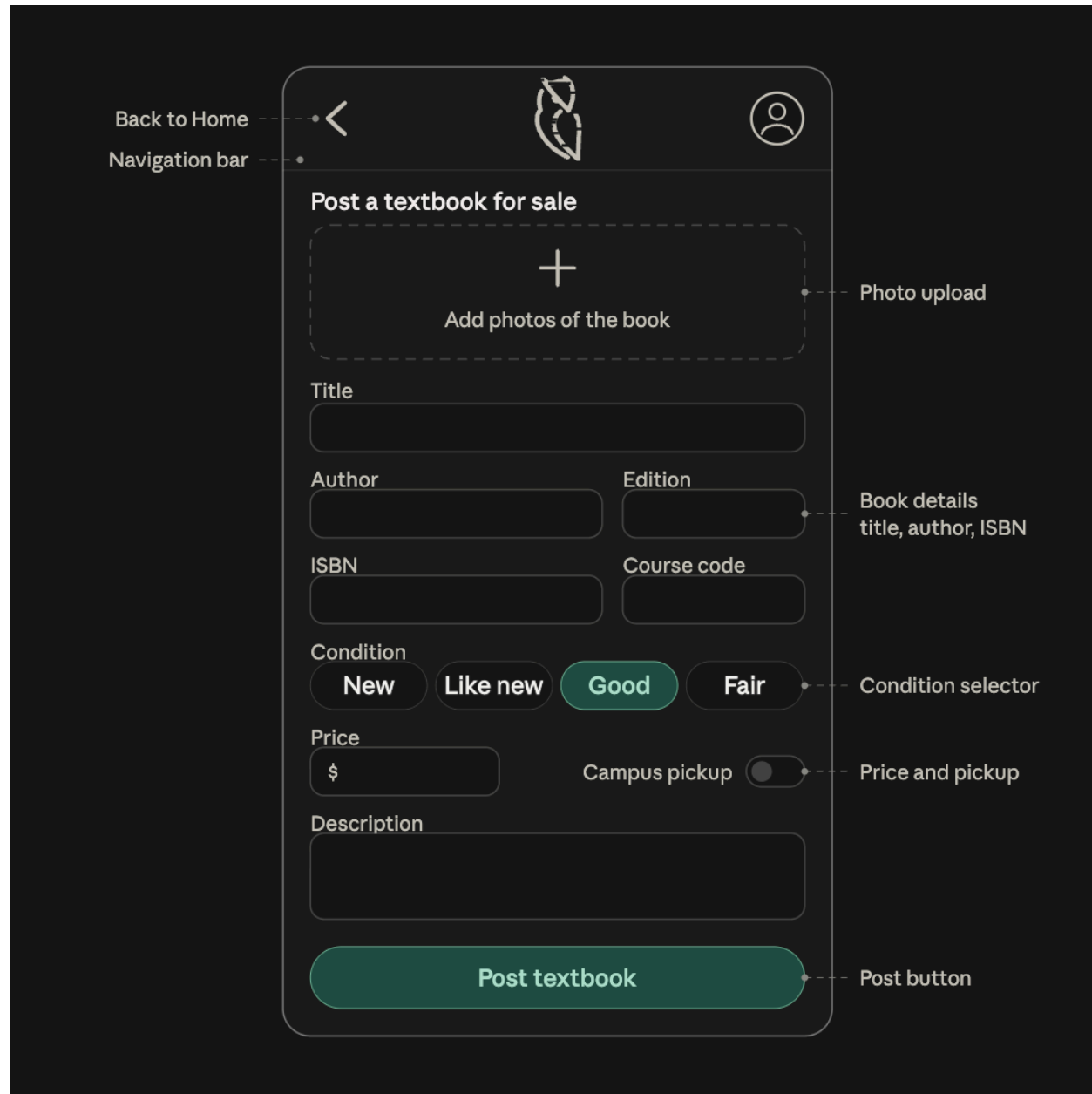
Design wireframes for your homepage and at least two other core pages. Your wireframes should:

- Clearly sketch where key information and interactive elements will be located. This must include placement of navigation bar and logo, and a layout of content across web pages.
- Focus on the homepage and at least two other pages.
- Reflect any feedback you received from your peers during the lab.

You can create your wireframes manually on paper, using draw.io or with AI tools ([Uizard](#), [Figma with AI plugins](#)).







5. Accessibility

In your answer document, explain how your product website will be made accessible from the start. Your plan should include:

- Specific features you will implement to support users with visual, hearing, motor and cognitive impairments.
- Tools you will use to audit your site for accessibility.

You may create this manually or with AI tools ([ChatGPT](#), [WAVE](#), [Google Lighthouse](#)).

Accessibility plan for Recyclopedia

Recyclopedia will be built to accommodate for visual, hearing, motor and cognitive impairments from the start, so every student can buy and sell textbooks.

Visual

- Alt text on all listing photos and the logo, and labels on icon buttons like the gear and profile picture
- High-contrast colors, with meaning never shown by color alone
- Text can be enlarged to 200% without breaking the layout
- Works with screen readers

Hearing

- Captions and transcripts for any video
- Notifications appear as text or email, never as sound alone

Motor

- Everything works with a keyboard, with a clear focus outline
- Large buttons (at least 44×44 pixels)
- No drag-only actions, and no time limits on forms

Cognitive

- Simple, plain wording and the same layout on every page
- Clear error messages, and a confirmation before removing items from the cart
- No autoplaying videos or flashing content